

S&P Global Flash Eurozone PMI®

Euro area output growth hits near three-and-a-half year high in September

September 2026

Flash Eurozone PMI Composite Output Index: 53.1 (August: 52.0). 41-month high.

Flash Eurozone Services PMI Business Activity Index: 53.0 (August: 51.6). 10-month high.

Flash Eurozone Manufacturing Output Index: 53.4 (August: 53.3). 55-month high.

Flash Eurozone Manufacturing PMI: 52.7 (August: 52.7). Unchanged pace of growth.

Provisional PMI® survey data from S&P Global signalled strengthening growth in the eurozone private sector during September. Output rose at the fastest pace since April 2023 amid solid expansions in both the services and manufacturing sectors. Rising business activity often reflected higher new orders. Meanwhile, the rate of job creation remained muted as confidence in the year-ahead outlook eased to a three-month low. Rates of input cost and output price inflation were sharp and the strongest since May.

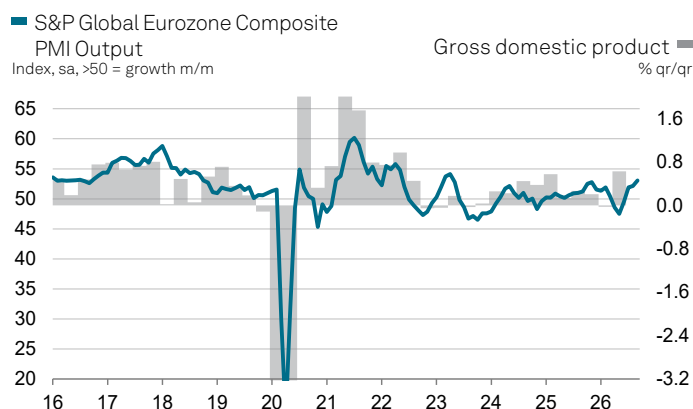
Output and demand

The seasonally adjusted S&P Global Flash Eurozone Composite PMI Output Index, based on approximately 85% of usual survey responses, rose to 53.1 in September from 52.0 in August. The latest reading signalled a third consecutive monthly expansion in business activity in the eurozone, and one that was the fastest in almost three-and-a-half years.

Solid growth was registered across both the manufacturing and services categories, with rates of increase quickening to 55- and 10-month highs, respectively.

The latest rise in output was also broad based across the different geographies covered by the data. Germany posted an expansion for the third month running, with the rate of growth the fastest in just under a year. Activity increased in France for the first time in 10 months, while the rest of the eurozone as a whole registered a solid but softer rise in output.

The picture for new orders at eurozone companies was similar to that for business activity, with growth recorded for the third month running in September. Here, the pace of expansion was the strongest since May 2022. Total new orders were supported by a further rise in new export business (which includes intra-eurozone trade). New export



Comment

Chris Williamson, Chief Business Economist at S&P Global Market Intelligence:

"It's no surprise to see inflationary pressures on the rise again in September, given the increase in energy prices emanating from the ongoing conflict in the Middle East, but more encouraging is the resilience of economic growth being reported. Accelerating business growth means the flash PMI survey is indicative of GDP rising at a quarterly rate of 0.4%, with order book growth picking up further momentum across both manufacturing and services in September to hint at sustained momentum heading into the fourth quarter.

"Manufacturing, spearheaded by Germany, is enjoying its best growth spell for over four years, spurred by rising AI and defense spending, but service sector growth is also perking up to signal a broad-based improvement in the economic growth story.

"The rate of job creation remains subdued as business confidence continues to be dampened by caution over geopolitics, notably the ongoing impact on energy prices and the cost of living. However, employment has edged higher again in September, up for a second month, to suggest more companies are returning to the jobs market.

"The resilience of economic growth amid the headwinds of geopolitical issues and rising prices will likely embolden the ECB to hike interest rates again before the end of the year, adding to the case for rates to rise sooner rather than later to put an October hike very much on the table."

orders increased for the second month running, after having decreased in each of the 53 months prior to August. The overall rise was centred on the manufacturing sector, while services new business from abroad continued to fall.

Employment

Sustained increases in new orders resulted in an accumulation of backlogs of work in September, the first since June 2022. Outstanding business rose across both monitored sectors.

Meanwhile, staffing levels increased for the second successive month, but only modestly and at the same pace as in August. Services employment rose, while manufacturers kept their workforce numbers unchanged over the month. The strongest job creation in Germany since mid-2023 contrasted with a further fall in employment in France. The rest of the euro area as a whole saw staffing levels increase modestly.

Inventories and supply chains

As was the case in August, eurozone manufacturing firms expanded their purchasing activity during September. The rate of growth remained modest, but quickened slightly from the previous month. The rise in input buying helped firms to keep their stocks of purchases broadly unchanged, after pre-production inventories had fallen in each month since February 2023. Stocks of finished goods were similarly broadly stable in September.

Suppliers' delivery times lengthened markedly again at the end of the third quarter of the year, despite the latest deterioration in vendor performance being the least pronounced since February.

Prices

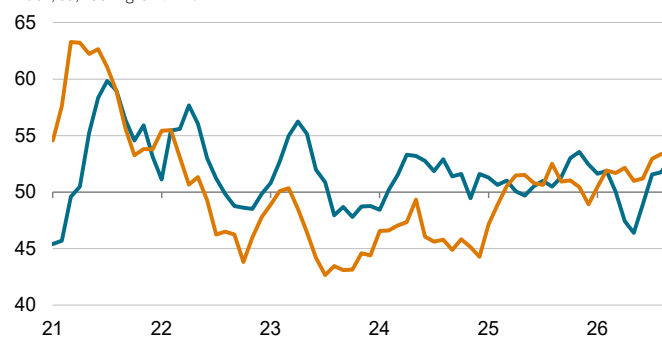
Inflationary pressures intensified in September, with both input costs and output prices increasing at the sharpest rates in four months.

The latest rise in input costs was faster than the average for the year-to-date, but remained softer than the recent peak seen in May. Accelerated cost inflation was registered across both the manufacturing and services sectors. Similarly, output prices increased at sharper rates in both monitored sectors, as well as across Germany, France and the rest of the eurozone as a whole.

Outlook

While rates of expansion in output and new orders quickened in September, confidence in the year-ahead outlook for output waned again during the month and remained relatively muted. Underlying data suggested that the overall drop in confidence was due to weaker optimism among French companies, while in Germany sentiment was unchanged from August and the rest of the eurozone posted a slight improvement in confidence. Lower optimism was seen in both manufacturing and services.

■ Eurozone Services PMI Business Activity
■ Eurozone Manufacturing PMI Output
Index, sa, >50 = growth m/m



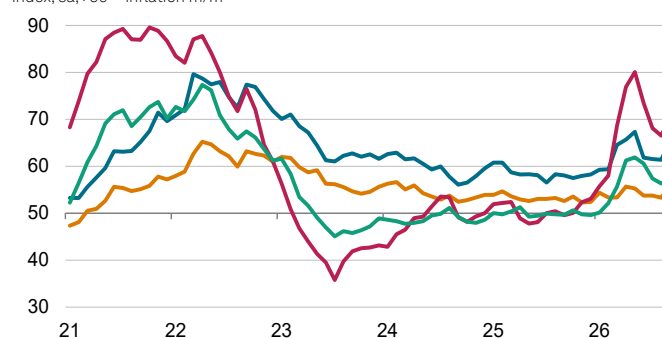
Source: S&P Global PMI. ©2026 S&P Global.

■ S&P Global Eurozone Manufacturing PMI
Index, sa, >50 = improvement m/m



Source: S&P Global PMI. ©2026 S&P Global.

■ Services PMI Input Prices
■ Services PMI Prices Charged
■ Manufacturing PMI Input Prices
■ Manufacturing PMI Output Prices
Index, sa, >50 = inflation m/m



Source: S&P Global PMI. ©2026 S&P Global.

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Methodology

Final September data are published on 1 October for manufacturing and 5 October for services and composite indicators.

The S&P Global Flash Eurozone Composite PMI® is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to survey panels of manufacturers in Germany, France, Italy, Spain, the Netherlands, Austria, Ireland and Greece, and of service providers in Germany, France, Italy, Spain and Ireland, totalling around 5000 companies. The panels are each stratified by detailed sector and company workforce size, based on contributions to GDP. The services sector is defined as consumer (excluding retail), transport, information, communication, finance, insurance, real estate and business services.

Survey responses are collected in the second half of each month and indicate the direction of change compared to the previous month. The following variables are monitored:

Manufacturing: Output, new orders, new export orders, backlogs of work, stocks of finished goods, employment, quantity of purchases, suppliers' delivery times, stocks of purchases, input prices, output prices, future output.

Services: Business activity, new business, new export business, outstanding business, employment, input prices, prices charged, future activity.

A diffusion index is calculated for each manufacturing and services variable, at the national level. The index is the sum of the percentage of 'higher' responses and half the percentage of 'unchanged' responses. The indices vary between 0 and 100, with a reading above 50 indicating an overall increase compared to the previous month, and below 50 an overall decrease. The indices are then seasonally adjusted.

Eurozone manufacturing and services indices are calculated by weighting together the national indices. National weights are calculated from annual manufacturing or services value added sourced from Eurostat.

Eurozone composite indices for are calculated by weighting together comparable Eurozone manufacturing and services indices using official eurozone manufacturing and services annual value added sourced from Eurostat.

The headline figure is the Composite Output Index. This is a weighted average of the Manufacturing Output Index and the Services Business Activity Index. It may be referred to as the 'Composite PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI, which is a weighted average of five manufacturing indices (including the Manufacturing Output Index).

The headline manufacturing figure is the Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index™ (PMI®). The PMI is a weighted average of the following five indices: New Orders (30%), Output (25%), Employment (20%), Suppliers' Delivery Times (15%) and Stocks of Purchases (10%). For the PMI calculation the Suppliers' Delivery Times Index is inverted so that it moves in a comparable direction to the other indices.

The headline services figure is the Services Business Activity Index. This is a diffusion index calculated from a single question that asks for changes in the volume of business activity

compared with one month previously. The Business Activity Index is comparable to the Manufacturing Output Index. It may be referred to as the 'Services PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI.

Flash data are calculated from around 80-90% of total responses and are intended to provide an accurate early indication of the final data. Since flash data were first processed, the average differences between final and flash index values for the headline indices are:

Composite Output Index = 0.1 (absolute difference 0.3)

Services Business Activity Index = 0.1 (absolute difference 0.3)

Manufacturing PMI = 0.0 (absolute difference 0.2)

S&P Global do not revise underlying survey data after first publication, but seasonal adjustment factors may be revised from time to time as appropriate which will affect the seasonally adjusted data series. Historical data relating to the underlying (unadjusted) numbers, first published seasonally adjusted series and subsequently revised data are available to subscribers from S&P Global.

For further information on the PMI survey methodology, please contact economics@spglobal.com.

S&P Global

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PMI by S&P Global

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